

CSC 311: Data Structures, Fall 2026

Syllabus

Department of Computer Science
California State University, Dominguez Hills

1. General Information

Class Time: TTh, 5:30 - 6:45 PM

Class Location: SAC 2102 **Prerequisites:** CSC 123 (Intro to CS and Programming II), MAT 281 (Discrete Math) / CSC 281 (Discrete Structure) and their prerequisites, with grade C or better.

Professor: Dr. Amlan Chatterjee

Email: achatterjee@csudh.edu

Class home page: <http://canvas.csudh.edu>

Office Hours: All office hours are held in NSM E-113 during the following time slot:

Day	Time
Thursday	3:30 PM - 5:30 PM

Textbook: This course is part of the Affordable Learning Solutions Open Textbook project. The scope of the course is covered by: Data Structures and Algorithm Analysis, Edition 3.2 Java version, by Clifford A. Shaffer. This textbook is made available by the author with information posted on the history of updates at <http://people.cs.vt.edu/shaffer/Book/>.

The url for textbook access is <http://people.cs.vt.edu/shaffer/Book/JAVA3elatest.pdf>.

The professor reserves the right to adjust the examination, workload, grading components, grading scale and schedule contained in this syllabus as necessary during the semester. Students will be informed of any changes to this syllabus in class.

Computer Information Literacy Expectations: It is expected that the student will:

- Use Microsoft Word for word processing unless otherwise approved by the instructor
- Be familiar with using email as a communication tool and check your official campus email account at least every other day
- Be able to access websites and online course materials which may require Flash and other plug-ins
- Use the library databases to find articles, journals, books, databases and other materials
- Be able to create an effective PowerPoint presentation
- Be able to record audio (ideally video) to share with the instructor via the web
- Have regular access to a computer and internet access for the term of this course

2. Topics to be covered

Overview, Measure of Algorithm's complexity, Arrays, Linked List, Stacks, Queues, Recursion, Sorting, Trees, Hash Tables, Graphs

Student Learning Outcomes:

1. An ability to analyze a problem, and identify and determine the computing requirements appropriate to its solutions
2. An ability to design, implement, and evaluate a computer-based system, process, component, or program to meet desired needs
3. An ability to use current techniques, skills and tools necessary for computing practice
4. An ability to apply mathematical foundations, algorithmic principles, and computer science theory in the modeling and design of computer-based systems in a way that demonstrates comprehension of the tradeoffs involved in design choices

3. Course Policies

Class Attendance: Class attendance is important because concepts and examples that are not in the text book will be discussed. The students are responsible for everything that is announced in class. Attendance is taken at the discretion of the instructor.

Class Email Alias: Urgent announcements will be sent through email. It is the student's responsibility to have university supplied email account forwarded to the location where the student reads email. Students are responsible for reading emails within 24 hours. A test message will be sent out by the instructor during the first week of class. If the student does not receive this message, it is the student's responsibility to get the problem resolved. For assistance in accomplishing any of these tasks, contact (310)243-2500.

Email Communication: University provided email account must be used for communication; email from other accounts might end up in spam and not answered. You must include your course number within square brackets in the subject of the email. For this course, the subject line must include the following: [CSC311]. Do not email the instructor any course assignments unless specifically asked for. All assignments must be submitted through Canvas. To avoid possible violation of FERPA for various electronic reasons, grades are never discussed via email. If you want to discuss anything related to grades, please make an appointment.

Extra Credit: There is no extra credit assignments available for this course. There are no "special" extra credit that is assigned to a single or sub-set of students. All work for credit is for the entire class.

Students graduating or having special requirements to pass the course: If you plan on graduating this semester, it is your responsibility to make sure you pass the course; there are no special privileges for students in the last semester at CSUDH, since it is not fair to other students. Also, if you are an international student, or a student who really needs to do well in this course (for any reason including scholarships), put in required effort to make sure you earn the grade.

Examinations: There will be two midterms and a final examination. The midterm examinations will be during class time. Missing an examination without a previously approved excuse will result in a grade of zero for that examination, and a F grade for the course. If an examination is missed for a verifiable, documented, and approved reason the percentage of the grade coming from the final examination will be increased accordingly. Makeup examinations are only available when required by University policy.

Final Examination: The final is comprehensive; no final examinations can be given early, except as required by University policy.

Quizzes: A number of short quizzes will be given in class during the semester. Quizzes will be announced either one lecture ahead or via email up to a day before the quiz. Failure to take 2 or more quizzes without a previously approved excuse or a verifiable, documented, and approved reason will automatically result in a F grade for the course.

Academic Integrity: Students are reminded of the university policy with regard to scholastic honesty. Academic integrity is of central importance in this and every other course at CSUDH. You are obliged to consult the appropriate sections of the University Catalog and obey all rules and regulations imposed by the University relevant to its lawful missions, processes, and functions. All work turned in by a student for a grade must be the students' own work. In this course, submission for credit of any assignment, program, test, or examination that is not the student's original work or contains portions of someone else's work (friend/tutor/Generative AI tool) without being clearly and specifically identified as such, as well as cheating on tests or examination, are violations that will automatically result in a F grade in the course and university disciplinary action.

1. Do not show another student a copy of your homework or projects before the submission deadline.
2. Do not email your project to another student, even if they promise they will not copy it.
3. The penalties for permitting your work to be copied are the same as the penalties for copying someone else's work.
4. Do not include content directly provided by a generative AI tool without understanding or being able to explain what it is and taking accountability for it.

CSUDH Academic Integrity policies are listed in the Catalog. Students are supposed to know what they are, including definitions of cheating, plagiarism, and dishonesty. The following link can be referred for additional information: <http://www4.csudh.edu/student-rights/academic-integrity/>.

Student Academic Appeal Process: Authority and responsibility for assigning grades to students rests with the faculty. A grade appeal is permitted when a student can show clear evidence that a grade was contrary to procedures as specified in the course syllabus, was based on prejudice, was capricious, or was the result of computational or clerical error. The presumption is that the grades assigned are correct until there is a clear demonstration otherwise. The burden of proof is heavy, and it rests with the student who is appealing.

Incompletes: The grade of I is intended for the rare circumstance when a student who has been successful in a class has an unexpected event occur shortly before the end of the class. I will not consider giving a student a grade of I unless the following three conditions have been met.

1. It is within two weeks of the end of the semester.
2. The student has a grade of C or better in the class.
3. The reason that the student cannot complete the class is properly documented and compelling.

Americans with Disabilities Act: CSUDH adheres to all applicable federal, state, and local laws, regulations, and guidelines with respect to providing reasonable accommodations for students with temporary and permanent disabilities. If you have a disability that may adversely affect your work in this class, I encourage you to register with Students disAbility Resource Center and to talk with me about how I can best help you. All disclosures of disabilities will be kept strictly confidential. NOTE: no accommodation can be made until you register with the Students disAbility Resource Center. For information call (310) 243-3660 or to use the Telecommunications Device for the Deaf, call (310) 243-2028 or go to: <http://www4.csudh.edu/dss/> or email dss@csudh.edu.

Behavioral Standards: Disruptions of class will not be permitted. Examples of disruptive behavior include:

- Allowing a cell phone or pager to repeatedly beep audibly.
- Playing music or computer games during class in such a way that they are visible or audible to other class members.
- Exhibiting erratic or irrational behavior.

- Behavior that distracts the class from the subject matter or discussion.
- Making physical or verbal threats to a faculty member, teaching assistant, or class member.
- Refusal to comply with faculty direction.

Behavior that persistently or grossly interferes with classroom activities is considered disruptive behavior and may be subject to disciplinary action. Such behavior inhibits other students' ability to learn and an instructor's ability to teach. The instructor may require a student responsible for disruptive behavior to leave class pending discussion and resolution of the problem and may also report a disruptive student to the Student Affairs Office (WH A-410, 310-243-3784) for disciplinary action.

The contents of course material provided by the instructor, the links contained therein directly and indirectly, and the contents of the said links, are copyrighted. They are provided exclusively for non-profit educational use by the students currently enrolled in this course and for the duration of this semester. No other use is allowed without authorization of the instructor in this course and copyright holder(s).

4. Assignments - Homework/Projects

Language: We will be using the Java programming language for the Projects. Projects in other programming languages are not allowed, except with explicit written permission from the instructor.

Projects: Incomplete projects may be turned in for partial credit.

- Projects which do not compile will receive no credit.
- If code for some portion of the project introduces errors that cannot be resolved, comment out that portion to receive credit for the logic.

Project Submission: Projects/Homework are due by 11:59 P.M. on the selected due date by uploading the project files to the Canvas course home page. Late projects/homework are not accepted. Failure to submit 2 or more projects/homework will automatically result in a F grade for the course.

5. Evaluation

Grading Components: The following components contribute to the course grade as shown in Table 1.

Component	Percent
Attendance	5
Quizzes	10
Projects/Homework	10
Midterm I	20
Midterm II	20
Final	35

Table 1: Course Grade Components

The grading scale will be no higher than as shown in Table 2. It may be lower at the discretion of the instructor.

Grading & Grade Corrections: A lot of time is spend in grading student work. Please take the time to review the grading to maximize your learning. After assignments have been returned, there is a one week period of time when grades can be disputed. After this time, the grades are final even if they are found to be in error. Demos for grading projects might be arranged at the discretion of the instructor; information about signing up for demo slots, if required, will be provided after project submission deadlines.

Grade	Percent
A	92.0+
A-	88.0 – 91.9
B+	84.0 – 87.9
B	80.0 – 83.9
B-	75.0 – 79.9
C+	70.0 – 74.9
C	65.0 – 69.9
C-	60.0 – 64.9
D+	55.0 – 59.9
D	50.0 – 54.9
F	Otherwise

Table 2: Final Grade Calculations

6. Tentative Schedule

Week	Topic
Week 1-2	Introduction & Complexity of Algorithms
Week 2-3	Arrays
Week 4-5	Stacks
Week 5-6	Linked List
Week 7	Midterm Test I
Week 8-9	Queue
Week 9-10	Recursion
Week 10-11	Sorting
Week 11-12	Hash Tables
Week 12	Midterm Test II
Week 13-14	Trees
Week 14-15	Graphs

Important Dates: This is a partial list for quick reference only. Check University approved Academic Calendar for an exhaustive list.

Labor Day Holiday, No Classes	Sep 7
Credit/No Credit and Audit Grading Deadline	Sep 17
Drop Without Record of Enrollment Deadline	Sep 18
Serious and Compelling Reason Drop/Withdraw	Sep 21 - Nov 6
Midterm I Exam	Oct 8
Veterans Day Holiday, No Classes	Nov 11
Serious Accident/Illness Required to Drop/Withdraw	Nov 9 - Dec 7
Midterm II Exam	Nov 12
Fall Recess, No Classes	Nov 23 - Nov 25
Thanksgiving Day Holiday, No Classes	Nov 26
Thanksgiving Break, No Classes	Nov 27 - Nov 29
Last Day of Classes	Dec 11
Final Exam	Dec 17